

SkyClean Drone Facade Cleaning

Wash skyscrapers and billboards from the ground — no ropes, no scaffolding, no risk.

What It Is

SkyClean is a drone-based exterior cleaning service that washes building facades, glass, and giant outdoor billboards using a tethered high-pressure cleaning drone. It replaces one of the most dangerous jobs in the trade — workers dangling on ropes and scaffolding — by doing the same work faster, safer, and with a fraction of the setup. Operators in markets like Peru are reportedly pulling \$12,000+ per contract.

How It Makes Money

You charge per project (per building or per billboard) or on recurring maintenance contracts. The economics are driven by danger pay and access difficulty: traditional rope-access and scaffold crews are slow and expensive, so a drone that cleans a tower in a day commands premium pricing. Buyers are property managers, commercial building owners, facility-management firms, hotels, malls, hospitals, and — the overlooked goldmine — outdoor advertising companies that maintain billboards for brands like KFC, McDonald's, and Coca-Cola.

Startup Costs

- Commercial cleaning drone (tethered, high-pressure, payload-rated): the core capital cost. Western/turnkey systems run \$25,000-\$50,000. **Sourcing from China via Alibaba** ("facade cleaning drone" / "high pressure cleaning UAV") can land a comparable unit at **\$8,000-\$18,000 per unit landed**, including ~\$1,500-\$3,000 sea/air freight and import duty.
- Pressure pump, hoses, filtration, and tank trailer: \$2,000-\$5,000
- Cleaning chemicals (eco-safe facade detergents): \$500-\$1,500 to start
- Pilot certification / commercial drone license (FAA Part 107 in the US, equivalent abroad): \$150-\$500
- Liability + equipment insurance: \$1,500-\$4,000/year
- Truck/van if not owned: \$0-\$15,000
- Branding, site, and local ads: \$300-\$1,000
- Total realistic startup: **\$13,000-\$30,000** sourcing the drone from China; \$30,000-\$60,000 buying Western.

This is a service built on a sourced capital asset — the drone is your money-printer, not resale inventory.

The Numbers

- Cost to service one mid-size facade (chemicals + labor + fuel + drone wear): ~\$400-\$900 per job
- Sell price: \$3,000-\$12,000 per contract depending on building height and surface area
- Profit per contract: roughly **\$2,500-\$11,000**
- Monthly projection: complete 4-6 jobs/month at an average \$4,000 = \$16,000-\$24,000 revenue; net **\$10,000-\$18,000/month** after costs once you're booked. A single recurring billboard-network contract (cleaned quarterly) can underpin a \$5,000+/month baseline.

How To Start

1. Validate locally: confirm no one in your city offers drone facade cleaning yet — being early is the whole edge.
2. Get your commercial drone license and check local airspace/permit rules for urban flight.
3. Source the cleaning drone — request samples and video proof from 3 Alibaba suppliers before buying; verify payload, tether, and pressure specs.
4. Buy insurance and form an LLC before you fly a single paid job — building owners require proof of coverage.
5. Do one free or discounted demo on a visible local building and film the before/after for marketing.
6. Pitch property managers and outdoor-advertising firms with the safety + cost-savings angle (no scaffolding permits, one-day turnaround).
7. Convert one-off cleans into quarterly maintenance contracts for predictable recurring revenue.

Where To Get Customers

- Commercial property management and facility-management companies (the biggest repeat buyers)
- Outdoor advertising / billboard operators (Lamar, Clear Channel equivalents and local boards)
- Hotels, malls, hospitals, and corporate HQs with large glass facades
- Construction and building-maintenance contractors who can subcontract you
- LinkedIn outreach to facilities directors + local commercial real estate groups
- A demo reel on Instagram/TikTok — the drone-cleaning footage is inherently viral and pulls inbound leads

Pro Tips

- Lead every pitch with safety liability: owners fear a worker falling off their building — a drone removes that lawsuit risk entirely, which justifies premium pricing.
- Chase billboard contracts hardest — they're standardized, recurring, and far less negotiation than bespoke building jobs, giving you a stable revenue floor.
- Buy a spare drone (or critical spare parts) early; downtime mid-contract kills your reputation, and Chinese-sourced units can have long replacement lead times.